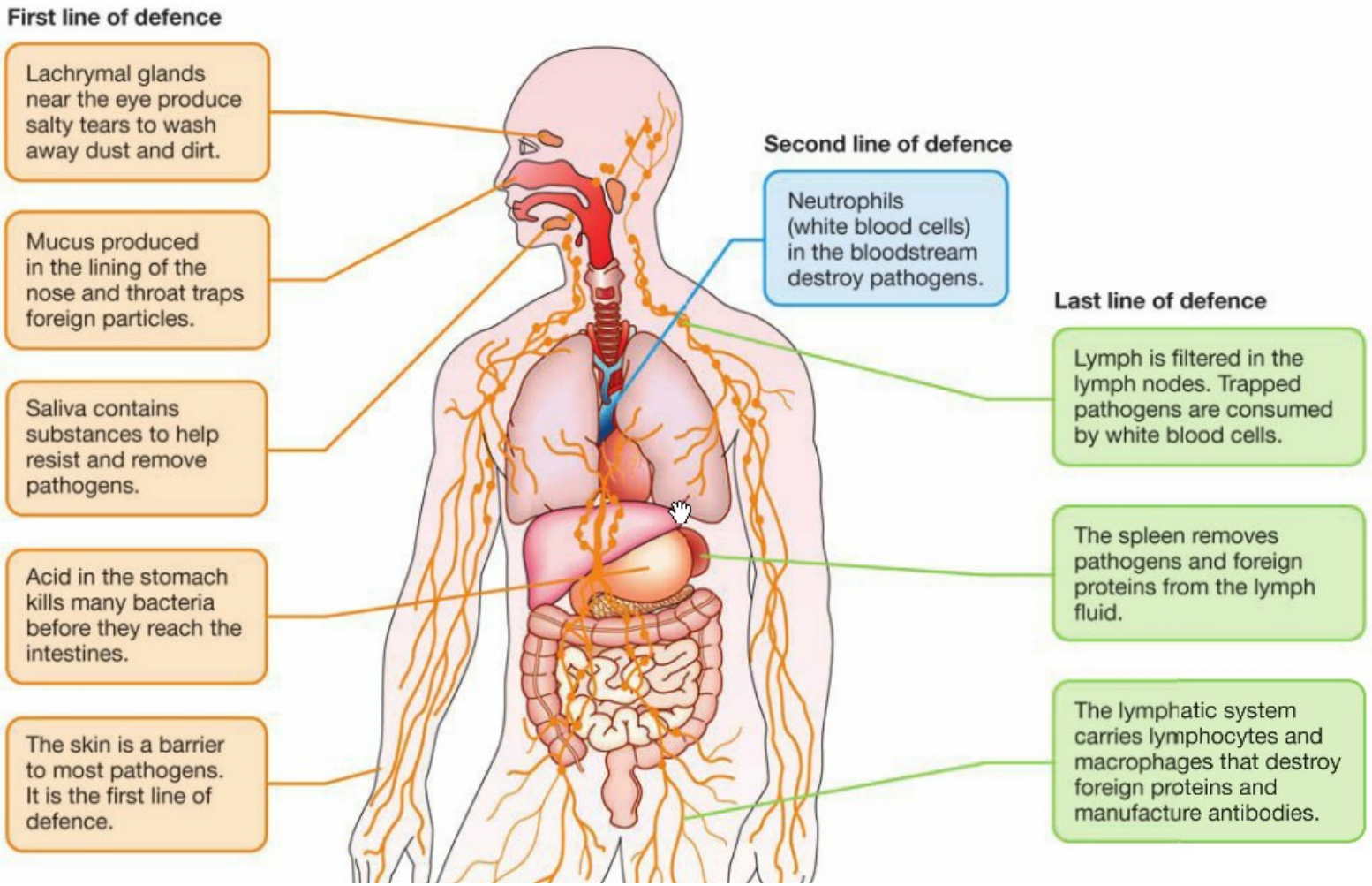

First line of defence
Lachrymal glands near the eye produce salty tears to wash away dust and dirt.
Mucus produced in the lining of the nose and throat traps foreign particles.
Saliva contains substances to help resist and remove pathogens.
Acid in the stomach kills many bacteria before they reach the intestines.
The skin is a barrier to most pathogens. It is the first line of defence.
Second line of defence
Neutrophils (white blood cells) in the bloodstream destroy pathogens.
Last line of defence
Lymph is filtered in the lymph nodes. Trapped pathogens are consumed by white blood cells.
The spleen removes pathogens and foreign proteins from the lymph fluid.
The lymphatic system carries lymphocytes and macrophages that destroy foreign proteins and manufacture antibodies.